Hormuz Hopes

S&P +1.02% to 6,700. Tanker crossings ease oil fears. Nvidia GTC lifts semis. VIX drops 13.5%. Bitcoin tops $74K.

THE SESSION

Wall Street snapped a three-week losing streak on Monday as easing Strait of Hormuz concerns and Nvidia's GTC conference lifted risk appetite across the board. The S&P 500 rose 1.02% to 6,699.85, reclaiming ground after Friday's close at 6,632 marked the index's lowest level of 2026. The Dow added 0.83% to 46,946, while the Nasdaq gained 1.22% to 22,374. The Russell 2000 advanced 0.94% to 2,503. The VIX fell 13.5% to 23.51, its largest single-day decline in weeks.

The catalyst was weekend news that select tankers—including a Pakistan-bound oil vessel—successfully transited the Strait of Hormuz, suggesting a degree of Iranian leniency toward certain energy shipments. Brent crude pulled back to roughly $102 per barrel after touching $105 earlier in the session. Treasury Secretary Bessent reportedly indicated the U.S. is facilitating a coalition to escort commercial vessels through the waterway, which further eased the energy supply premium that had been building for weeks.

Semiconductors led the session with the VanEck Semiconductor ETF rising 1.7%. Nvidia gained 1.65% to $183.22 ahead of CEO Jensen Huang's GTC keynote, where he projected $1 trillion in purchase orders for the Blackwell and Vera Rubin chip platforms through 2027—double the company's prior estimate. Meta rose nearly 3% after reports that the company plans to lay off up to 20% of its workforce in an efficiency push tied to AI adoption. Goldman Sachs gained 2.15% and Caterpillar added 2.09%, helping the Dow outperform. Credit-sensitive sectors benefited broadly as yields retreated across the curve.

IOWN Tactical: The S&P 500 remains roughly 4% below its recent high. No tactical triggers are in play. Today's bounce was constructive—the VIX dropping back below 24 suggests the worst of the fear premium is fading—but the index would need sustained follow-through above 6,750 to suggest the correction has fully stabilized. Ownership means accepting that relief rallies and renewed pullbacks are both part of the process.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

ETHA +10.82% — DIGITAL ASSET ETF

iShares Ethereum Trust surged as crypto rallied broadly on the risk-on session. Ether outpaced Bitcoin by a wide margin.

HUT +5.94% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Hut 8 advanced alongside the crypto complex. Bitcoin pushed above $74K as easing geopolitical fears reignited risk appetite.

FINV +4.77% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Chinese fintech rose as risk sentiment improved and emerging market names attracted buyers on the broader rally.

TOL +4.01% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Toll Brothers climbed as falling yields and easing oil fears improved the homebuilder outlook. The company recently unveiled new home designs in Kirkland, WA.

COIN +3.98% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Coinbase gained with the crypto rally. Bitcoin above $74K drove exchange volumes higher.

DECLINERS

SUPV –1.71% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Argentine bank continued to give back recent gains. Emerging market financials faced profit-taking amid the broader sector rotation into U.S. equities.

GPC –1.64% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Genuine Parts declined as investors digested the 9–12 month timeline for its planned corporate separation. The stock has been under pressure.

BKH –1.04% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Black Hills pulled back modestly after Friday's 2.56% gain. Utilities lagged the broader rally as investors favored higher-beta sectors.

MARA –0.97% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Marathon Digital dipped despite Bitcoin's advance. The stock gave back some of Friday's 6.39% surge.

ATAT –0.85% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Atmus Filtration declined modestly on light volume. No material catalyst.

HOLDINGS NEWS

NVDA — GTC 2026 keynote. Jensen Huang projected $1 trillion in Blackwell and Vera Rubin purchase orders through 2027, unveiled the Kyber rack architecture prototype (144 GPUs, vertical compute trays), and detailed the company's NemoClaw open-source enterprise AI agent platform. The stock rose 1.65% to $183.22.

SYK — Strong rebound. Stryker surged 3.80% to $349.56, recovering sharply from last week's cybersecurity incident

disclosure. The company stated that no patient data was compromised and operations continue normally.

LRCX — Semiconductor strength. Lam Research gained 3.39% to $219.40, riding the GTC-fueled semiconductor rally. Analysts continue to highlight growing foundry and logic market opportunities.

AMD — IP license deal. Advanced Micro Devices rose 1.65% to $196.58. The company announced a multi-year intellectual property license agreement with Adeia, expanding its technology access.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✓ BEAT ONE

+0.73%

vs. DVY +0.37% | IWS +0.83%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✓ BEAT

+1.44%

vs. IUSG +1.25%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +6.03% vs DVY +6.82% / IWS +3.28%
Growth –0.74% vs IUSG –4.41%